

one point to another that's going to be one of the challenging aspects—how the data comes to the station and is then disseminated to the user. We're solving that challenge by building a dashboard where users can come to a website. They'll be able to see a map and they can draw a rectangular cross-section or some sort of polygons. And we will deliver the data for that particular area.

Are there any competitors that you are dealing with? What would you say makes GalaxEye stand out?

There are a few global players who are already there, but we will compete with them by advancing our technology. There are people who are doing satellite imagery using single sensor based imaging. Where we come in is the multi-sensor fusion. That's where we differentiate ourselves.

We've done Avishkar Hyperloop in the past and we have some sort of know-how of how deep tech projects really move ahead. Second, we are lucky to have mentors who have been working in this field. So, it's

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the entire team of founders, employees, and mentors that's our biggest strength.

Apart from that, it's also the differentiation that we bring to the table that's very important for the customers. Generally, when you enter space tech, you don't always think about the customer. You only think about making the technology

feasible. But our focus has been to serve the customer from day one. I think our customer-centric approach and our team capacity are our advantages.

What are your future plans?

Our mission is to launch a constellation of satellites working in tandem to provide imagery. We will have a group of such satellites monitoring the earth on daily basis. That's where we will be heading, and that is the ultimate goal. However, the short-term goal is to launch our first satellite, probably by the end of next year. We would definitely have to collaborate with one of the launch providers for this. We are in active talks with a lot of people, but we would prefer to launch through ISRO.

What are the future plans for your startup in terms of hiring and investments?

We have been funded once in the past. Last year, we raised one round of funding. As of now, we actively engage with investors, but funding plans are still not very open. To talk about hiring, in SaaS and many other domains of startups, it's very easy to find people and talent. In our case, we need some hands-on experience—either electronics or very deep knowledge of the fundamentals of electronics or engineering. We are on a constant lookout. We always look out for good talent to join us.

We need people to design components, test components, and then we need people to communicate and make the fabrication happen as well. We're currently working on a small scale, but we are constantly expanding. Anyone and everyone who has an interest in working in space tech and has got good fundamentals of electronics can always reach out to us.

Generally, we look out for people who have some sort of communica-

tions experience, someone who has worked on transmit/receive modules, antenna design, sensor design, or the RF side of electronics. We

OPTOELECTRONICS, RF, ANTENNA, AND FPGAS—THESE ARE THE FOUR KEYWORDS WE LOOK FOR.

have observed that people coming fresh out of college are actually more effective than people who are coming from the industry, may be because there was no private satellite industry earlier. Many of our team members are also freshers. So, we generally look for people who can learn fast and unlearn fast, and then implement.

How do you think students interested in space technology at an undergraduate level should proceed?

I think the Indian government and ISRO have been taking steps towards that. There is a student satellite programme of ISRO where they have asked students to submit proposals. Students will actually build CubeSats using ISRO's know-how, and they can put them up on the PSLV rocket and send them into space. At the same time, universities like IIT Madras are coming up with interdisciplinary programmes, where there will be a space based course. So, efforts are being made.

Also, to understand space and other things, it is very important to understand the physics behind it. I think drones are a good way to enter this domain. Students can start by working on quadcopters. They can find such kits on multiple e-commerce websites. So that should be a good start. **EFY**